

Herbert Flor

Bringing more than two decades of experience in the design and management of urban planning projects through all stages, including significant expertise in multi-disciplinary collaborations.

Master Planning & Urban Design

herbert.flor@yahoo.com

+971 56 433 6391

Senior urban development and master planning professional with experience across large-scale communities from concept to implementation across the UAE and wider GCC.

Led the development of Development Control Regulations (DCR) frameworks, strengthening governance, land-use control, and compliance with authority approvals and infrastructure capacity constraints.

Developed structured mechanisms to manage master plan variations, including land-use change controls aligned with GFA limits, traffic thresholds, and utility demand requirements.

Experienced in leading multidisciplinary and international consultant teams, coordinating with government authorities, and managing stakeholder engagement across complex development environments.

Contributed to master plan optimization initiatives aimed at improving land value, development efficiency, and overall project performance.

Core Competencies

Master Planning, Development Control & Design Delivery Experience

- **Project Management.** Led urban planning and master planning projects of varying scale across the UAE and GCC, coordinating multidisciplinary teams, international consultants, and stakeholder engagement with local and federal authorities. Integrated Development Control Regulations (DCR) and Land Use Change Cap frameworks into project delivery to ensure compliance and alignment with strategic master plan objectives.
- **Manuals, Guidelines & Development Control.** Developed and maintained planning manuals, urban design guidelines, and Development Control Regulations (DCR), enabling structured implementation, consistent design outcomes, and effective land-use control across multiple developments.
- **Analysis.** Conducted spatial and thematic analysis using GIS to support evidence-based master planning, informing design decisions and scenario testing across large-scale developments.
- **Land-Use Governance & Compliance.** Designed and implemented Land Use Change Cap frameworks to evaluate master plan variation requests, ensuring compliance with GFA allocations, infrastructure capacity, traffic thresholds, and utility demand constraints.
- **Design Development.** Supported concept development and master planning through spatial concepts, hand sketches, and digital refinement, translating early-stage ideas into coordinated master plans aligned with strategic objectives and market positioning.
- **Presentation & Visualization.** Produced high-quality master plan presentations, including 2D illustrated plans, 3D visualizations, rendered models, and animated outputs using advanced design and visualization tools to support stakeholder communication and approvals.

Major Achievements

- At Dubai Holding Land Estate, contributed to the development and refinement of Development Control Regulations (DCR) frameworks and Land Use Change Cap mechanisms across large-scale master-planned communities, strengthening land-use governance, regulatory compliance, and structured evaluation of master plan amendments in alignment with strategic development objectives.
- Spearheaded the development of Ras Al Khaimah’s Addressing Manual, establishing emirate-wide standards for street naming and property numbering. This strategic initiative led to the successful launch of the Ras Al Khaimah Addressing System (2021), now fully implemented and supported by a dedicated digital addressing platform.
- Contributed to the development of Ras Al Khaimah’s first Neighborhood Design Guidelines Vol. 1: Emirati Residential Neighborhood and Public Realm Design Guidelines by authoring the initial draft framework, shaping foundational standards for community design and public realm quality.

Skills

Project Management	Design	Graphics	3D Modeling & Rendering	GIS AND CADD
• Team Leadership • Stakeholder Coordination • Contract and Consultant Management • Progress Reporting • Quality Control and Assurance	• Concept Design • Urban Design • Master Planning	• Adobe Creative Suite • Photoshop • Illustrator • InDesign • Adobe After Effects	• 3ds Max • SketchUp • V-Ray for 3ds Max and SketchUp	• ArcGIS Pro • ArcMap • AutoCAD • MicroStation • MXRoads

Professional History

Dubai Holding Land Estate
Dubai, UAE
Senior Manager - Development (2025 – Present)
(Currently on notice period)

- Led the development and enhancement of Development Control Regulations (DCRs) across multiple large-scale master-planned communities, ensuring alignment with strategic objectives and regulatory compliance
- Standardized DCR documentation through a unified template framework, improving consistency, clarity, and control across all developments.
- Reviewed and validated authority-approved GFA allocations and land-use compliance, ensuring adherence to planning approvals and development parameters.
- Collaborated with Operations and Infrastructure teams to refine development controls, integrating updated utility demand projections and traffic generation data while ensuring consistent built-form outcomes.
- Developed and implemented a Land Use Change Cap framework, streamlining evaluation of master plan variation requests while ensuring compliance with GFA limits, RTA traffic thresholds, infrastructure capacity, and community facility provisions—without additional cost exposure to the master developer.
- Led the technical and commercial assessment of developer-led master plan amendments, evaluating impacts on land-use distribution, infrastructure capacity, community facilities, and overall project integrity.
- Contributed to master plan optimization initiatives, proposing strategic adjustments to enhance market attractiveness, improve land value, and maximize development returns.

Ras Al Khaimah Municipality Department

Ras Al Khaimah, UAE

Senior Urban Planning Specialist (2014 – 2025)

- Led and managed all phases of planning projects, from initial concept development through preliminary master plan and detailed design stages.
 - Directed the development of detailed master plans for residential developments totalling 300 ha, managing the coordination with utility, roads, and traffic disciplines to ensure the delivery of complete master plan packages for local citizens.
 - Spearheaded the creation of concept master plans for numerous residential developments exceeding 3,000 ha, including the conceptual design for a comprehensive Academic City.
 - Managed the development of design concepts for the public realm revitalization of historic and heritage areas in Ras Al Khaimah, in collaboration with government agencies and private developers.
 - Oversaw the preparation of a concept structure plan for a large-scale project site spanning over 18,000 ha. on a greenfield area.
 - Developed and managed the creation of the Addressing Manual for Ras Al Khaimah Emirate. This involved establishing comprehensive guidelines for street-naming and numbering across the entire Emirate, culminating in its official launch in 2021 and ongoing full implementation.
 - Provided guidance and support to the GIS Center during the implementation of the Addressing System, addressing queries related to thoroughfare type identification, numbering sequences, and other critical aspects.
 - Conducted extensive research and benchmarking to inform the development of planning standards for Emirati communities, culminating in the Neighborhood Design Guidelines Vol. 1: Emirati Residential Neighborhood and Urban Design Guidelines.
 - Managed the creation of master plan reports using Adobe InDesign, integrating supporting graphics developed in Photoshop and Illustrator to effectively communicate project outcomes.
 - Directed the visual communication of project designs by creating 3D models (SketchUp, 3ds Max) and producing compelling still and fly-through animation renders (3ds Max, V-Ray). Managed the post-production process using Adobe After Effects to create engaging presentations with motion graphics, text, notes, and music.
 - Prepared and delivered strategic PowerPoint presentations to higher management and external stakeholders, effectively communicating project vision and progress.
 - Utilized Geographic Information System (GIS) thematic mapping capabilities to conduct comprehensive site analysis and identify potential areas for future development.
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Parsons Corporation

Dubai, UAE

2005-2014

Junior Urban Planner (2008 – 2014)

Assistant CADD Supervisor (2007 - 2008)

CADD Draftsman (2005 – 2007)

- Contributed to the full master planning process, from site analysis and concept development through to detailed master plan delivery for large-scale residential developments across the GCC.
- Produced comprehensive site analysis diagrams illustrating existing conditions, infrastructure, surrounding developments, and connectivity, forming a key component of concept design reports and client presentations.
- Developed framework and structure plans defining residential clusters, community centers, land-use distribution, open space networks, and road hierarchies, supporting iterative design reviews and refinement processes.
- Prepared detailed master plans and neighborhood cluster layouts, integrating urban design principles such as walkability, placemaking, circulation, and landscape strategy for client presentations and approvals.
- Designed building concepts and typologies, including apartment elevations inspired by regional architectural character (KSA), as well as villa and duplex layouts in coordination with senior architects and client representatives.
- Delivered 3D models and high-quality renderings of buildings and master plans to support visualization, stakeholder engagement, and marketing presentations.
- Developed parcelization and building-loading plans, optimizing land use efficiency and supporting development feasibility.
- Supervised CADD production teams, ensuring high-quality drawing outputs under tight deadlines while coordinating with multidisciplinary teams (roads, utilities, infrastructure).
- Led early adoption of ProjectWise within Parsons Middle East offices, improving document control, drawing management, and revision tracking workflows.
- Streamlined planning workflows by developing automated area calculation systems in MicroStation and exporting plot data to Excel, significantly reducing manual input time.
- Supported 3D road and infrastructure modeling using MX Roads, contributing to integrated design development.
- Managed drawing submissions and documentation workflows using Aconex, ensuring compliance with project and contractual requirements.
- Authored and implemented a CADD Manual, standardizing drafting procedures and improving consistency across project deliverables.

Projects

Dubai, UAE: Arabian Canal, Emirates Tourism Village, Bawadi Project, Warsan Community, Emirates Investment Park, The Lagoons, Dubai Healthcare City II, Dubai Biotechnology and Research Park, Jebel Ali Village, Business Bay Extension(Muhammad Bin Rashid Canal), Culture Village Phase 2, Reem Development, Arabian Ranches 2

Sir Bani Yas Island Abu Dhabi, UAE Ajman MAG Island Ajman, UAE Qetaifan Islands Doha, Qatar Ministry of Housing Project, King Abdullah Economic City Kingdom of Saudi Arabia Mirbat Resort Oman Dounya Parc, Algiers Algeria

Parsons Corporation

Doha, Qatar

2004-2005

CADD Draftsman

V.V. Soliven Group of Companies

Manila, Philippines

2004

Architectural Designer

Peak Development Inc.

Makati City, Philippines

2003-2004

Architect

RSP Lim Construction Co. Inc.

Manila, Philippines

2002

Project Architect

Parsons Corporation

Makati City, Philippines

2001-2002

Associate Designer

Education

Bachelor of Science in Architecture

Bicol University, Philippines

2000

License & Certification

Architect

Philippine Professional Regulation Commission (PRC)

Jan. 2001

PRC No. 16456

Distinction

8th Placer**Licensure Examination for Architects**

Philippine Professional Regulation Commission (PRC)

Jan. 2001
